

Artist Statement

This project helped me understand how creating games can make arguments not just through story, but through rules and choices. My game shows that AI interviews are not a good way to evaluate who you are as a worker, but are good to evaluate how well you demonstrate the personality traits it is looking for, such as professionalism and obedience. The rules of the game are designed so that different personality types lead to different outcomes, showing how AI systems can reward people who say the “right” things rather than those who are actually qualified. By making this a game with multiple paths and endings, I wanted players to experience the frustration of trying to figure out what the AI wants to hear instead of being evaluated fairly. If this project were a static story, opposed to a game, the argument would not be as strong because the reader would not have to make choices. The interactive game format forces the player to make decisions about how to act in the interview, and then experience the consequences of those decisions. This helps each player understand how AI systems work by simulating a real interview instead of just reading about AI interview fails and stories.

AI helped me brainstorm the storyline ideas. However, I chose the theme, wrote the main story, decided the endings, and made the game's argument myself. The hardest part of interactive narrative was ensuring that all the branches made sense and connected back to the main idea, while still keeping the game interesting enough to hold each player's attention.

Design Statement

My interactive story is about AI job interviews and how AI is changing how people are evaluated in hiring processes. The game starts with the player in an interview with an AI system and asks them to respond to questions in different ways, such as honestly, professionally, or confidently. The purpose of the game is to show that AI interviews are not actually an accurate way to evaluate a candidate's ability to do a job, but instead evaluate keywords and personality performance.

In my game, the most important choices are how the player chooses to present themselves to the AI interviewer. For example, if the player answers honestly, the AI penalizes them for not sounding enthusiastic enough. If the player makes a joke, the AI rejects them because it does not value humor. If the player uses corporate language and says professional sounding phrases, the AI rewards them and moves them forward in the hiring process. If the player questions the AI or shows too much independence, the AI rejects them for not fitting into the company culture. These choices matter because they show that the AI system is not evaluating qualifications, but instead evaluating whether the candidate behaves in the way the system expects.

The rules and mechanics of the game support the theme by creating a system in which certain personality traits are rewarded, and others are punished. This is an example of procedural rhetoric, where the game makes an argument through its rules. By forcing the player to navigate the AI interview and experience the outcomes of their choices, the game argues that AI hiring systems can be unfair and ultimately unrealistic because they reduce people to personality traits and data points instead of understanding them as individuals.